S HARSHA BHAT

AI Security & Penetration Testing | Freelance

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Services

- LLM application security testing: direct and indirect prompt injection, jailbreak and guardrail bypass, memory and context isolation review.
- Web application and API penetration testing (OWASP WSTG) with CVSS-scored reports and code-level remediation.

Experience

Security Consultant (Freelancer) - Mindpex July - Aug 2026

- Exploited direct prompt injection on an unauthenticated LLM endpoint that passed raw user input verbatim to the model, and indirect injection via persistent memory poisoning that influenced later model outputs.
- Identified an LLM context store with no tenant isolation (any caller could read or write any employee's memory by UUID), an unvalidated context field with no provenance control, and raw LLM exceptions leaking infrastructure details; delivered code-level remediation.
- Assessed the platform across 7 security domains using OWASP WSTG, documenting 30+ CVSS-scored findings (14 Critical, 17 High) including SSRF confirmed out-of-band with interactsh, account takeover, and BOLA.

Associate Product Developer - Epicor Software, Bengaluru Sep 2026 - Present

- Re-tested 5 penetration testing defects with Burp Suite and manual API manipulation, uncovering 3 incomplete fixes (CSP unsafe-inline bypass, BOLA user-data exposure, JWT post-logout invalidation failure); returned tickets in Jira with reproduction PoCs.

Product Development Intern - Epicor Software, Bengaluru Oct 2025 - Sep 2026

- Engineered a PowerShell cleanup script deployed across 5 agent VMs via a weekly ADO pipeline, clearing ~50 GB of logs and temp data per run and eliminating pipeline failures from storage exhaustion.

Projects

AI Jailbreak & Prompt Injection Research Independent

- Practiced guardrail bypass using role-play persona framing and encoding/obfuscation (base64, leetspeak) across gamified prompt-injection labs (Gandalf, HackAthena-style challenges) and authorized client test applications.
- Tested indirect prompt injection through documents, web content, and persistent memory to evaluate how untrusted input crosses LLM trust boundaries.
- Translated findings into mitigation guidance on input validation, context isolation, and output handling, aligned to the OWASP LLM Top 10.

Black-Box Web Pentest - Powerdialer (Github Repository) Jun 2026

- Performed an authorized OWASP WSTG assessment with Burp Suite, ffuf, and Gobuster, validating authentication, authorization, API, and WebSocket controls.
- Identified BOLA, exposed OAuth client credentials, and CORS misconfiguration; scored with CVSS and documented remediation on least privilege and secret management.

VigiLynx - Winner, HackAthena'25 Cybersecurity Track (Live Web App | Github) Apr - June 2025

- Implemented a Random Forest URL-classification pipeline analyzing 1,000+ URLs with real-time browser alerts via a Chrome extension.
- Integrated VirusTotal threat-intelligence APIs to automate malware verdicts across 50+ scanned files.

Skills

- **AI Security:** Prompt Injection (Direct and Indirect), Jailbreak and Guardrail Testing, LLM Security, AI Trust Boundaries, OWASP LLM Top 10
- **Application Security:** OWASP WSTG, API Security, SSRF, BOLA, Authentication, Authorization, CVSS Reporting
- **Programming:** Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, PowerShell, Bash, SQL
- **Tools:** Burp Suite, interactsh, ffuf, Gobuster, Nmap, curl, sqlmap, Semgrep, Jira, Azure DevOps

Certifications and Achievements

- CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) - June 2026
- ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) - Feb 2026
- Winner - HackAthena'25 Cybersecurity Track (National Hackathon)
- Solved 200+ CTF Challenges | Top 10% Ranking on TryHackMe

Education

New Horizon College of Engineering, Bengaluru Nov 2022 - July 2026

B.E. in Information Science and Engineering, CGPA: 8.57